Milo de Vries

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Professional Statement

Over the last decade I've gone from founding and scaling a climate-tech startup to leading product strategy at South Pole, building and coaching teams to ship SaaS products with measurable impact. Skilled at translating strategy into high-velocity roadmaps, running discovery alongside delivery, and resolving scope and stakeholder disputes before they escalate. Driven by building the right thing, lean, fast, and with conviction.

Core Competencies

Product Strategy & Roadmapping • Team Leadership & Mentorship • SaaS & B2B Platforms • Agile / Lean Product Development • Stakeholder Management • User Research / UX Collaboration • AI/ML Integrations • ClimateTech Solutions • Market Analysis • Fundraising & Investor Relations

Technical Skills

SaaS Architecture & Integrations (REST/GraphQL APIs) • Data & Analytics (SQL, BI tools) • AI/ML Integrations • Cloud & DevOps (AWS, GCP, Terraform) • Security & Identity Management (IAM) • Python • JS/TS

Professional Experience

Product Lead — South Pole BV, Amsterdam (Apr 2022 – Present)

South Pole helps organisations realise deep decarbonisation pathways across industries.

Scope & Responsibilities

- Directed product and technical strategy across multiple SaaS initiatives spun out of the Accelerator (Climate Risk Tool, CSRD Gap Tool), taking them from ideation through PoC, MVP and scale.
- Led the technical side of the SME->Enterprise Climate Solution: drove architecture, UX design, and user testing. Contributing to market analysis, product strategy, design and evaluation of AI integrations.
- Coordinated South Pole's Accelerator for six early-stage climate-tech applications, defining business cases, assessing PoCs and guiding roadmaps.
- Co-developed an AI-assisted PCF (product carbon footprinting) tool.
- Conceived an offensive PR effort to restore South Pole's reputation in nature based offsetting. For this devised and scoped an open-source forest-impact calculator using satellite imagery and ML

Key Achievements

- Took multiple SaaS products from concept to launch, collectively serving 30+ enterprise clients and realising seven-figure revenue within 24 months.
- Delivered the SME Climate Solution MVP in 6 months with full UX/user-testing cycles.
- Built and launched a no-code double-materiality-assessment tool in 4 months, reducing manual work for consultants.
- Led IAM/SSO integrations across two enterprise tools, including the first integration to go live under new security requirements.

- Delivered a 10× performance improvement on the Climate Risk tool.
- Architected and realised the first AI-assisted PCF prototype.

Founder & CEO — CO_2ok, Utrecht (Apr 2017 – Mar 2022)

CO_2ok enables consumers to make their shopping climate neutral

Scope & Responsibilities

- Founded and grew CO_2ok from concept to acquisition; led strategy, product, development, fundraising and team building.
- Designed and launched a seamless, often tailored, integration product for online retailers across multiple e-commerce platforms.
- Brought a second product from concept to market and made a data-driven decision to sunset it and focus on the core product.
- Developed sales and marketing strategies and oversaw onboarding and support.
- Negotiated an acquihire by South Pole.

Key Achievements

- Built and led a multidisciplinary team of 10+, secured seed funding and partnerships.
- Onboarded 50+ merchants and enabled tens of thousands of compensated transactions, making climate-neutral shopping easy for consumers.
- Personally landed first major client through a tailored evidence-based pitch.
- Created and launched a second product, grew it to 100+ users.
- Delivered a successful founder exit while ensuring continued growth of the product and team.

Earlier Roles (selected):

- Senior Systems Engineer, e-Village (2015–2016)
- Senior DevOps Engineer, Unitt (2014–2015)
- DevOps Developer, Springest (2014)
- System Engineer / Security Lieutenant, Info.nl (2007–2013)

Education

- MITx – Introduction to CS & Data Science (2016)
- Stanford – Startup Engineering (2013)
- Architecting on AWS (2014)
- Technical University Eindhoven – Computer Science / Electrical Engineering (partly completed)

Languages

Dutch (native) • English (fluent) • German (fluent)

Interests

Designing (climate-tech) startups • Adventures with my daughter Nova Skiing/snowboarding • Technology • IT security/digital privacy